BEING \'ETALE IS FPQC LOCAL ON THE BASE

THE STACKS PROJECT AUTHORS

Editorial note. All delivered mathematical text is the author's own, copied verbatim from the pinned Stacks Project chapter file spaces-descent.tex; no statement or proof step was rewritten, reordered or removed.

Editorial note. The counted span cites one Morphisms of Spaces lemma and one Descent lemma plus same-chapter items, recorded in assembly.external_references with canonical tags as navigation pointers.

Allowed standard prerequisites (editorial).

- Framework lemma for descending properties of morphisms. Stacks Project, Descent on Spaces, Lemma lemma-descending-properties-morphisms. Supplies the criterion structure that the proof verifies.
- \'.Etaleness is \'etale-local on the source. Stacks Project, Morphisms of Spaces, Lemma spaces-morphisms-lemma-etale-local. Supplies assumptions (1), (2) and the chart reductions.
- fpqc descent of \'etaleness for schemes. Stacks Project, Descent, Lemma descent-lemma-descending-property-etale. Supplies the final descent step for U \to Z.

Source reference. Original lemma 041J: sources/stacks-chow/tags.txt, source lines 5294–5294. Cross-chapter standard prerequisite cited by the author inside the counted span; it is used as a pointer and its own proof is not part of this item.

Source reference. Original reference 03XT: sources/stacks-chow/tags.txt, source lines 5160–5160. Cross-chapter standard prerequisite cited by the author inside the counted span; it is used as a pointer and its own proof is not part of this item.

Source reference. Original reference 02VN: sources/stacks-chow/tags.txt, source lines 3774–3774. Cross-chapter standard prerequisite cited by the author inside the counted span; it is used as a pointer and its own proof is not part of this item.

Lemma 0.1. *The property $\mathcal{P}(f) =$"f is étale" is fpqc local on the base.*

Proof. We will use Lemma 041J to prove this. Assumptions (1) and (2) of that lemma follow from Morphisms of Spaces, Lemma 03XT. Let $Z' \to Z$ be a surjective flat morphism of affine schemes over S. Let $f : X \to Z$ be a morphism of algebraic spaces, and assume that the base change $f' : Z' \times_Z X \to Z'$ is étale. We have to show that f is étale. Let U be a scheme and let $U \to X$ be surjective and étale. By Morphisms of Spaces, Lemma 03XT again, it is enough to show that $U \to Z$ is étale. Since f' is étale, and since $Z' \times_Z U$ is a scheme étale over $Z' \times_Z X$ we conclude (by the same lemma again) that $Z' \times_Z U \to Z'$ is étale. As $\{Z' \to Z\}$ is an fpqc covering we conclude that $U \to Z$ is étale by Descent, Lemma 02VN as desired. □

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